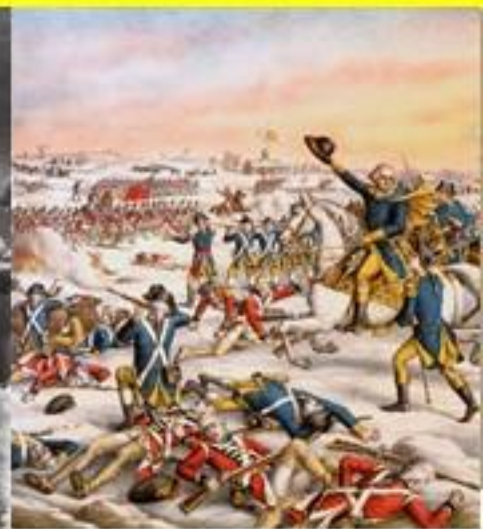


WORLD HISTORY

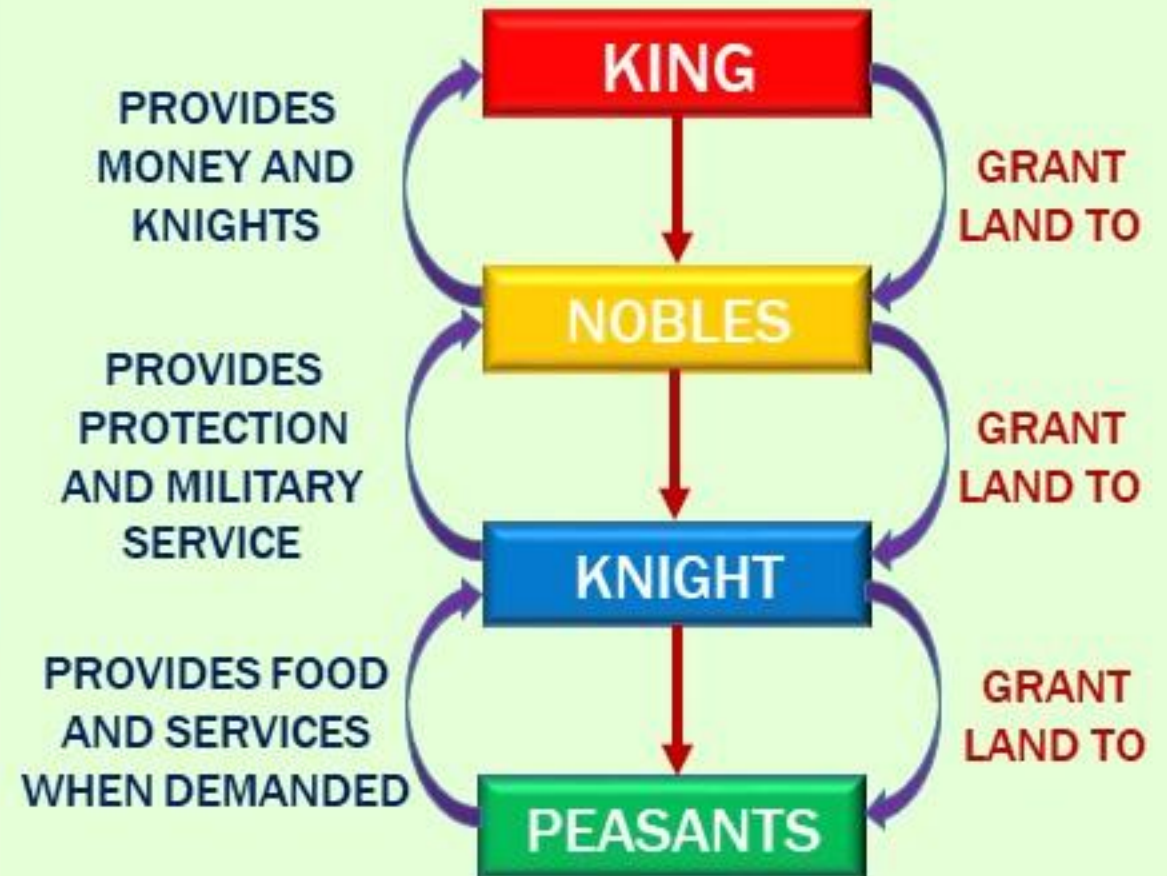


MODULE-2

FEUDALISM-2

GROWTH OF FEUDALISM

- 1** Feudalism is derived from the Latin word "Feudum" and translated into English as "Fief".
- 2** A new type of society and a new system of government rose in western Europe following the break-up of Roman empire. The new order that gradually emerged is feudalism.
- 3** In this society the most powerful elements were the chiefs who, with their military following, dominated large tracts of land and also played an important part in government.



GROWTH OF FEUDALISM

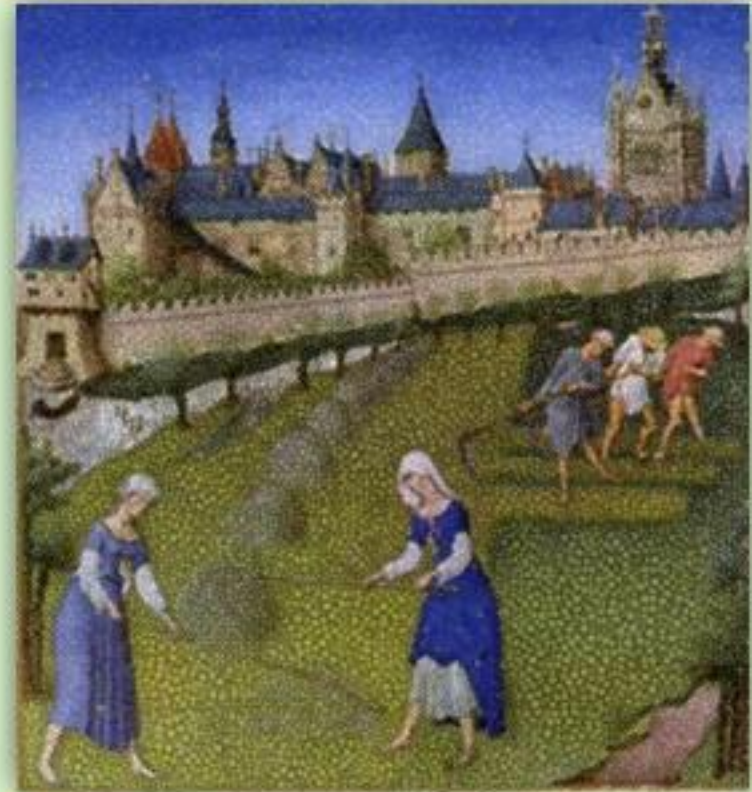
4 In course of time the monarchy became stronger and an attempt was made to limit the power of the chiefs.

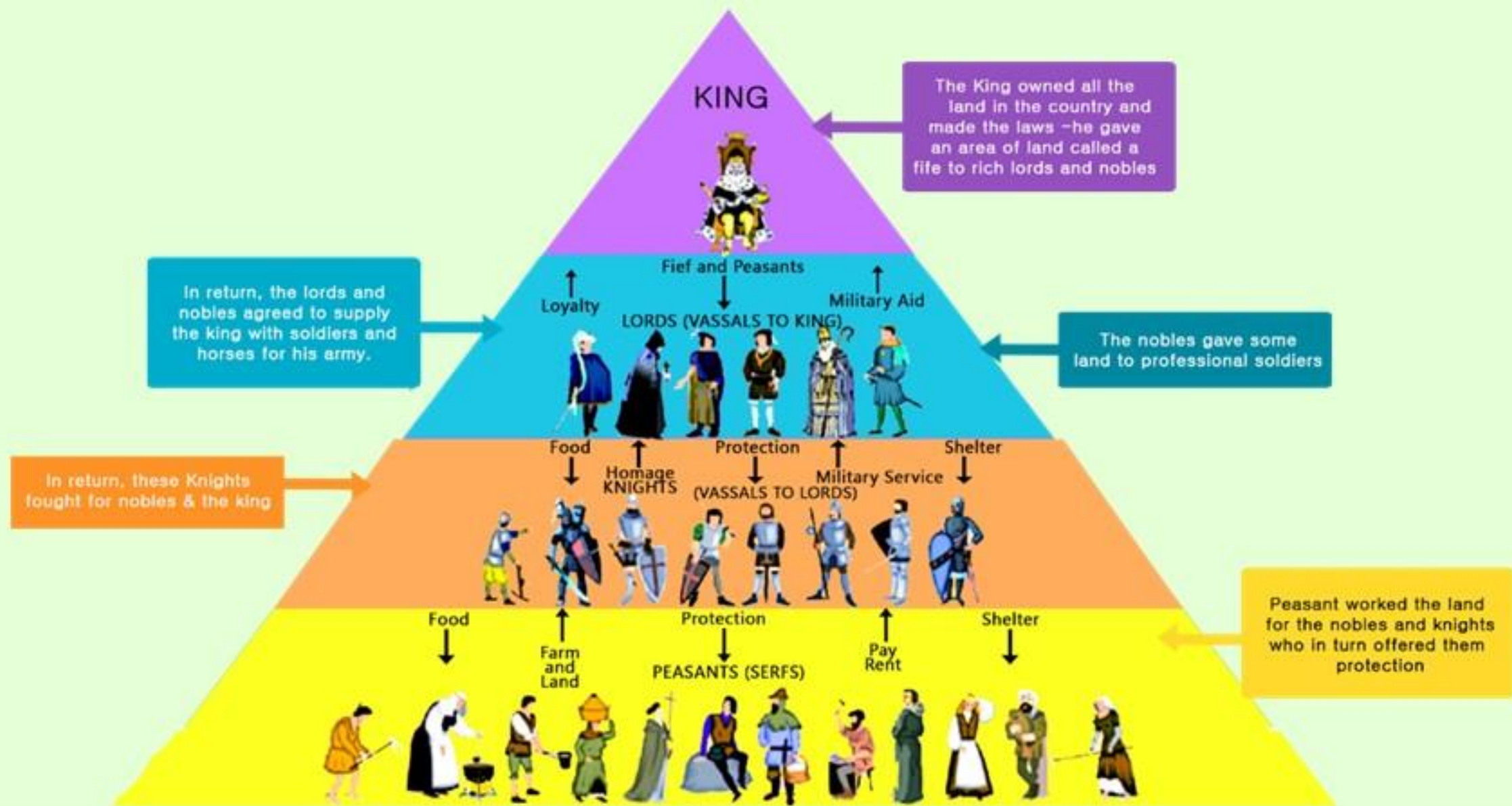
5 One method of doing so was that the king swore the chiefs to an oath of loyalty as his vassals and in return, recognised the tracts of land dominated by their fiefs.

6 The chiefs, in return, could appoint sub chiefs as vassals, and allot a tract out of their fief to them.

7 Thus, in the feudal system, government was dominated by a landed aristocracy.

8 The aristocracy was hereditary and tried its best not to admit outsiders to its fold.





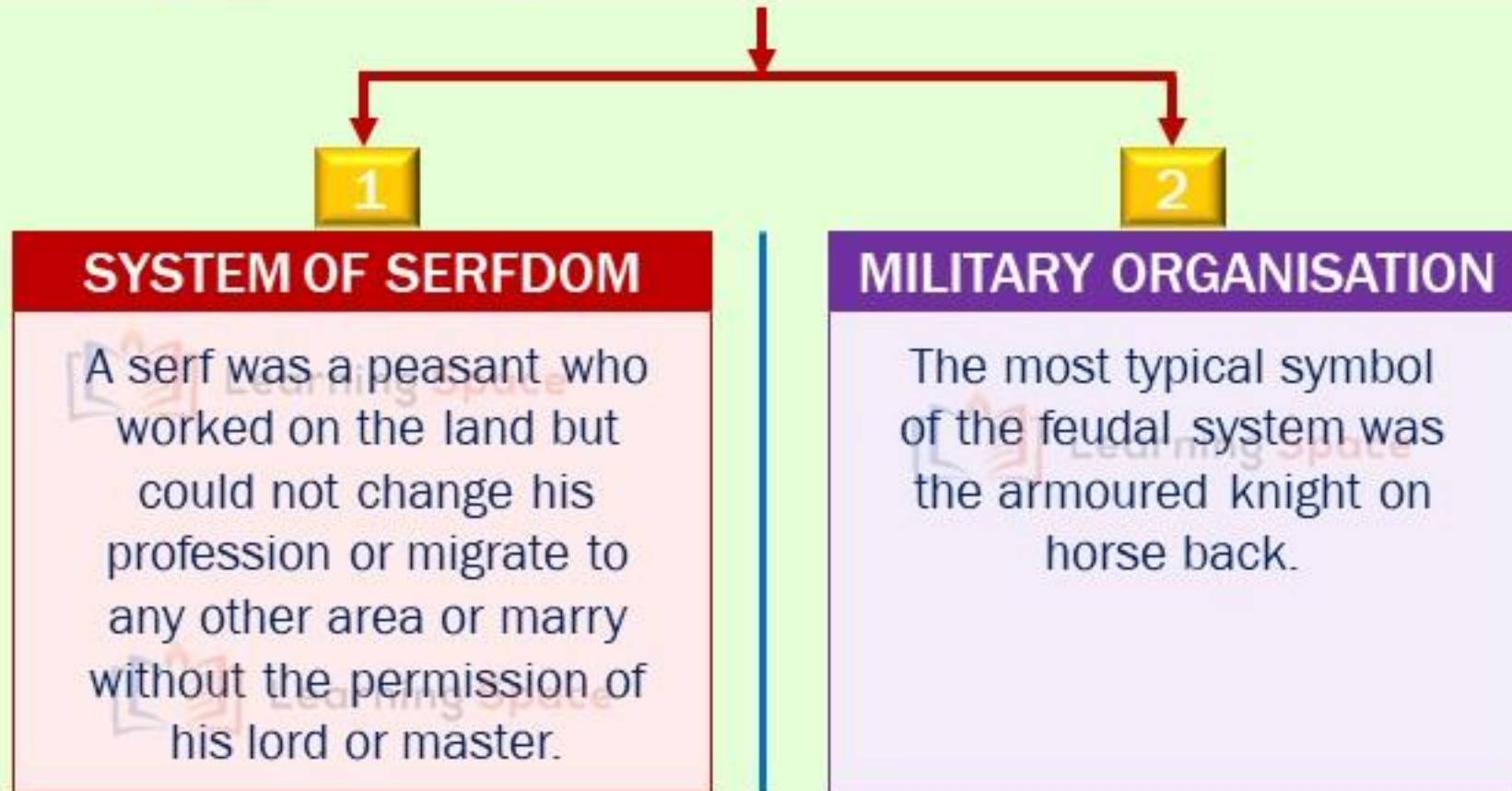
ARE THERE ANY SIMILARITIES WITH INDIA AND OTHER COUNTRIES?

- There are many similarities between this system and the system of government and society evolved by the Turks in central Asia and by Rajputs in India.
- As the system developed, it assumed various forms in different countries due to difference in conditions and traditions.



TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

In Europe, the feudal system is associated with two other features.



TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

1 SYSTEM OF SERFDOM

1 In many of the European countries, large tracts of land were owned by the lords of these manors.

2 A part of the land was cultivated by the lord directly with help of the serfs who had to divide their between cultivating their own fields and fields of their masters.

3 The lord and manor also had the responsibility of maintaining law and order, dispensing justice etc.

4 Since there was a great deal of lawlessness in those days, even free peasants were sometimes prepared to accept the vassage of the lord of the manor in return for protection.





The lord of the manor lived in a large stone house called the manor house.

The village church was built on a small piece of land that belonged to the lord.

Sheep grazed on grassy fields, and villagers used sheep's wool to make clothes.

Peasants grew vegetables in small gardens near their houses.

In the fall, peasants worked to harvest crops like wheat.

The village blacksmith made iron tools for farming.

Harvested wheat was taken to the mill and ground into flour, which was used to make bread.

TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

1

SYSTEM OF SERFDOM

DO WE FIND THIS KIND OF SYSTEM IN INDIA?

- In India, for instance, there was no serfdom and manor system as such.
- But, the local landed samantas exercised many of the powers of the feudal lords and the peasantry was in a dependant position to them.

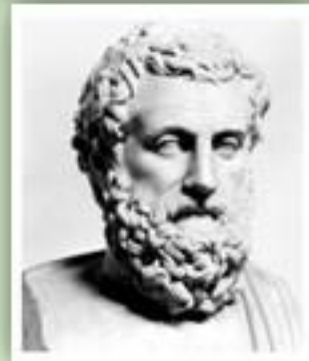


TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

1 SYSTEM OF SERFDOM

HAVE CLARITY ON SLAVES AND SERFS

- 1** In economic terms, first Greece and Rome transformed slavery into a systematic production.
- 2** Slaves had no right over himself and was considered as a property to his master.
- 3** Aristotle called the slave “as a property with a soul”
- 4** Rome called slave as an “instrument with vocals”- a tool with voice.



TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

1 SYSTEM OF SERFDOM

HAVE CLARITY ON SLAVES AND SERFS

- 5** The existing slaves started settled down as serfs and gradually increased their status.
- 6** The only difference is slaves were brought and sold anywhere anytime,
- 7** Whereas, serf could not be sold apart from the land he worked on. But, when the land sold to another lord by his present land owner, he gets transferred to the new lord.



TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

2 MILITARY ORGANISATION

- 1** The second feature associated with the feudal system in Europe is the system of military organisation.
- 2** The most typical symbol of the feudal system was the armoured knight on horse back.
- 3** No king could hope to maintain out of his own resources the large body of cavalry needed and to provide them with the armour and equipment.



TYPES OF FEUDAL SYSTEM

2 MILITARY ORGANISATION

- 4 Hence the army was decentralised assigning to the fief-holders. The responsibility of maintaining a fixed force of cavalry and infantry for the service of the king.
- 5 Cavalry warfare became the principle mode of warfare.
- 6 However, when the economy shifted from land based to the money based economy, king made the centralisation of army and was by this time in a position to maintain the army with increase in reserves in the treasury due to trade activities.



ROLE PLAYED BY THE CHURCH

- 1** Apart from the system of feudalism, the pattern of life in Europe during what is called the medieval period was also shaped by the Christian church.
- 2** We have already referred to the role of Greek Orthodox Church in the Byzantine empire and Russia. In the absence of a powerful empire in the west, the catholic church took on some of the functions of government as well.
- 3** The Pope, who was the head of the catholic church, became not only a religious head but one who exercised a great deal of political and moral authority as well.



ROLE PLAYED BY THE CHURCH

- 4** With the influence of grants of land from the princes and feudal chiefs, and donations from rich merchants, many monastic orders and monasteries were set up. Many monasteries gave medical help or shelter to the travellers.
- 5** They also served as centers for education and learning. In this way, the catholic church played an important role cultural life of Europe.
- 6** However, some of the monasteries became exceedingly wealthy, began to behave like feudal lords. This led to internal discord and conflict with the rulers who resented the worldly power of the church and the popes.



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